



Periodontal Flap Surgery

Purpose: Lifting the gums to clean the roots of teeth and repair bone damage caused by gum disease.

First 24 Hours:

- Keep the surgical dressing in place if provided.
- Avoid rinsing, spitting, or using a straw.
- Rest with your head elevated.

Pain & Swelling:

- Mild discomfort and swelling are expected.
- Take prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Apply ice packs to the face for 20 minutes on/off during the first 6–8 hours.

Bleeding:

- Slight bleeding or pink saliva is normal for 1–2 days.
- Apply gentle pressure with gauze if bleeding increases.

Oral Hygiene:

- Avoid brushing the surgical site until cleared by your dentist.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinse as directed.
- Brush and floss other areas normally.

Diet:

- Soft foods for several days.
- Avoid hard, crunchy, or spicy foods.

Follow-Up:

- Stitches may dissolve or require removal in 1–2 weeks.
- Contact the office if swelling worsens, pain increases, or bleeding persists beyond 48 hours.